

recommendations regarding a product. A review or recommendation is far more worthy if it comes in the way of a personalized message and a user is far more likely to purchase a product if his close associate had something favourable to say about it. Such messaging apps can also provide secure connections between buyers and sellers via the messaging app platform which can be used to provide product update statuses and for solving grievances. Major retailers currently send product statuses through the SMS service. Using a messaging service not only allows for visual media updates (the product's picture while being shipped can be sent to the consumer) but also allows for non intrusive interactions safely. Most users find a message as a better alternative rather than a call from a ecommerce company informing them of their purchase status. Hike also offers direct sharing of messaging and files through Hike Direct over WiFi Direct. Imagine walking into a Mall or store and receiving updates over Hike Direct about a product's latest discount offers or a new launch?

Hike messenger started a viral campaign centred on privacy and received a wide upsurge in user base. The messaging app has lately offered group calling feature wherein it's possible to call multiple users once inside a group, a handy tool that can be of immense use for brands looking to market their product or service. Another popular feature of Hike is the sms facility wherein a user can also contact and send messages to people who are not using data services. Hike messenger detects broken conversations and sends messages through SMS if the other user gets off data and is unique in offering such a service.

Hike messenger has also initiated plans for integrating its messaging app with ecommerce, something that was done earlier in China by WeChat. Hike currently offers news services which work just like any other chat contact list. It also offers live updates for cricket. Simply open up the contact chat and see live scores or scroll through news items. Hike messenger is also integrated with Hoppr, the coupon offering service which has major brands like Amazon on board.

Messaging apps can be a powerful tool for marketing but brands need to come up with creative ways for utilising their fullest potential. Most mes-

